

Political Science: Be A Topper Guide

Exam-Oriented Study & Revision Strategy (2023-2024 Analysis)

1. MOST REPEATED QUESTIONS (HIGH PROBABILITY)

- **The European Union:** Process of evolution from an economic to a political union (6-marker).
- **UNSC Reforms:** India's claim for permanent membership and general member criteria (6-marker).
- **Earth Summit (1992):** Rio outcomes: Agenda 21 and Sustainable Development (2/4 marks).
- **New Security Threats:** Non-traditional sources like terrorism and health epidemics (6-marker).
- **NITI Aayog:** Reasons for replacing the Planning Commission (1/2 marks).
- **Post-1989 Politics:** Mandal issue, NEP 1991, and Coalition era consensus (4/6 marks).

2. PART A: WORLD POLITICS FOCUS AREAS

- **End of Bipolarity:** Soviet disintegration causes and India-Russia post-Cold War relations.
- **New Centers of Power:** China's economic policies and the "Miracle on the Han River" (South Korea).
- **South Asia:** Challenges to democracy in Pakistan and the role of SAARC/SAFTA.
- **Environment:** Control over oil (Resource Geopolitics) and Global Commons.

3. PART B: INDIAN POLITICS FOCUS AREAS

- **Nation Building:** Sardar Patel's role in integrating states and the States Reorganization Commission.
- **Congress System:** 1969 Split (Syndicate vs. Indira) and the landmark 1967 elections.

- **Democratic Resurgence:** 1975 Emergency causes (Rail strikes, Bihar movement) and 1977 downfall.
- **Foreign Policy:** Non-Alignment (NAM) and India's Nuclear Policy (refusal of NPT/CTBT).

4. QUESTION PATTERN & SCORING STRATEGY

MCQs (12 Marks)

Focus on **Chronology** (Timeline of treaties) and **Assertion-Reason** (Conceptual clarity from NCERT).

Map & Cartoon (8 Marks Total)

Map: Locate states of first non-Congress gov (Kerala), 1962 war (Arunachal), and leader home states.

Cartoon: Review UN intervention failures and US Hegemony (Gulf War themes).

Long Answers (6 Marks)

Always use **Introduction → Headings → Bullet Points → Conclusion**. Note: Always choose the "OR" option you can write more points for.



Quick Revision Checklist

- ☐ Memorize 6 UNSC membership criteria.
- ☐ List the 4 major post-1989 developments in India.
- ☐ Differentiate Traditional vs. Non-traditional security.
- ☐ Draft the timeline of EU formation (1948-1992).
- ☐ Identify key politicians' home states for Map questions.